Alida Angafor

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Areas of specialization: Philosophy of cosmology, philosophy of time, philosophy of mind, epistemology (self-locating belief), metaphysics of the self, philosophy of artificial intelligence

EDUCATION

M.A., Philosophy · Central European University, Vienna, Austria · 2024–2026

- Thesis: "Understanding the First-Person Viewpoint from the Third: Some Remarks on Being Someone." Supervisor: Lisa Doerksen.
- The thesis argues that the subjectivity of phenomenal consciousness, the fact that every experience is for someone, is grounded in a persisting subject rather than a self constituted only within momentary experience. It engages Nagel, Biro, Zahavi, Strawson, representationalist theories of consciousness, and no-self views.
- Graduate coursework: Laws of Nature (Ferenc Huoranszki); Objectivity (Maria Kronfeldner); Advanced Epistemology and Beliefs and Desires (Katalin Farkas); Epistemology (Phyllis Pearson); Ethics (Simon Rippon).

B.A., Philosophy and Sociology, Minor in Astronomy · Dartmouth College, Hanover, NH · 2017–2021

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Where Do We Go Between Experiences? Existential Subjectivity and the Self in Experience" · Journal article in preparation, drawn from M.A. thesis

- Distinguishes existential subjectivity, the persisting subject that experience depends on, from experiential subjectivity, the self as it shows up within experience. Argues that a subject cannot be just its conscious experiences.

"Misalignment as Evidence of Human Error, Not Machine Agency" · Independent research project, 2026

- Argues that attributions of agency to AI systems rest on Dennett's intentional stance, which cannot distinguish genuine from as-if agency. Proposes that apparent AI agency is an unforeseen consequence of human optimization choices in training, so that misalignment reflects error and epistemic limits on the designers' side rather than machine agency.

"Whose Lie Is It? Agency Attribution in AI Deception Evaluations" · Independent research project, 2026

- Argues that describing model outputs as deceptive rather than erroneous presupposes a thick notion of agency (belief, goal ownership, a first-person standpoint) that current evaluations assume but do not test. Includes a two-experiment protocol testing perspective invariance and goal ownership in language model behavior.

Self-locating belief and the experience of time · PhD research project in development

- Asks what the mismatch between the block universe and our experience of time's passage implies about the reality of subjective experience, and whether there is a rational way to set self-locating credences.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Prof. Brad Skow · Department of Linguistics and Philosophy, MIT · Jan–Mar 2021

- Supported research on how the sciences understand cause and effect, providing summaries of relevant literature.

Research Assistant to Prof. Maron Greenleaf · Department of Anthropology, Dartmouth College · 2021

- Produced a historical literature review on development, inclusion, and exclusion.

Human Development Research Fellow · John Sloan Dickey Center for International Understanding, Dartmouth College · 2018–2021

- Completed six terms of paid research assistantships on faculty-led, field-based projects aimed at alleviating poverty in low-income countries.

Research and Policy Intern · Latin America Youth Center, Washington, DC · 2014–2015

- Designed and administered surveys on adolescent drug use and analyzed results to produce policy recommendations.

FELLOWSHIPS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- Human Development Fellowship, John Sloan Dickey Center for International Understanding, Dartmouth College, 2018–2021
- Central European University Master's Scholarship (tuition and stipend), 2024–2026
- Dartmouth College Undergraduate Scholarship (partial tuition, room and board), 2017–2021
- Federal Pell Grant (partial tuition), 2017–2021

GRANTS

- PLATO Grant for Philosophy Programs, 2017. Funded a philosophy essay competition I organized for peers at Columbia Heights Educational Campus.

AWARDS AND DISTINCTIONS

- Abramson Foundation Scholarship Award, 2017–2021
- Future Business Leaders of America Scholarship Award, 2017–2021
- Black Youth Achievement Award, Springbrook High School, 2014

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

- CS 2881R: AI Safety, Harvard University (Prof. Boaz Barak), external participant, Fall 2026

TEACHING

Astronomy Teaching Assistant · Appalachian Mountain Club, Bretton Woods, NH · Jun–Aug 2019

- Designed and delivered public astronomy lectures for general audiences, including children.

Teaching Assistant · Dartmouth Leadership Attitudes and Behaviors Program · Jan–Apr 2019

- Facilitated structured discussions on values and ethical reasoning in leadership.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Therapist Understudy · Nashoba Learning Group, Massachusetts · Sep 2026–present

- Deliver one-to-one instruction based on applied behavior analysis to students with autism spectrum and related disorders, under the mentorship of senior clinical staff.
- Collect and record behavioral and skills data (frequency, duration, and antecedent-behavior-consequence) across academic, daily living, and vocational programs to track student progress.

Child Welfare Caseworker · Chaffee County Department of Human Services, Salida, CO · Nov 2023–Aug 2024

- Managed a caseload of child welfare cases, where decisions about a child's safety often had to be made from evidence that was incomplete and still unfolding.
- Conducted welfare assessments with families, listening closely to each person's account while weighing it against what could be observed and documented.
- Built an Excel tracking system to hold competing case deadlines in view, so that no family's needs slipped through the cracks.

Crew Leader · SouthWest Conservation Corps · Mar–Nov 2023

- Led conservation field crews through long seasons of outdoor project work, coordinating each day's tasks while keeping the crew safe and working well together.
- Learned to make steady decisions in changing conditions, and to hold a group together when the work was hard and the days were long.

Field Staff · Elements Wilderness Therapy; Pacific Quest

- Lived and worked in the field alongside young people in wilderness therapy programs, supporting their daily routines and the therapeutic goals set by their clinical teams.
- Practiced patience and close attention in a setting where trust had to be earned slowly, and where small moments often carried the most meaning.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS AND ORGANIZATIONS

- Minorities and Philosophy (MAP), Central European University chapter, member, 2024–present
- Central European University Philosophy Club, member, 2024–present
- Dartmouth College Philosophy Club, member, 2018–2021
- Columbia Heights Educational Campus Philosophy Club, founder, 2015–2017

SKILLS

- **Languages:** English (native), Spanish (conversational), German (elementary)
- **Programming:** Python, C++, HTML, CSS

REFERENCES

Available upon request